

scripts/check-emulator-runner-tag.sh — User Guide

Last verified: 2026-06-02 (anti-forgetting enforcement cycle)

Inheritance: §6.X clause (c) (Container-Submodule Emulator Wiring Mandate); HelixConstitution §11.4.18 (script docs)

Classification: universal

Overview

Makes §6.X enforcement clause (c) mechanical at the check-constitution.sh / pre-push layer: every **NEW** emulator/Challenge attestation evidence file that records emulator execution **MUST** declare runner: containers-submodule (or runner=containers-submodule). A new evidence file that records an emulator run with a raw/host-direct runner tag — or NO runner tag — FAILS.

Previously clause (c) was paper-only ("rows lacking this declaration are rejected by scripts/tag.sh"). This scanner closes the anti-forgetting gap on the NEXT bad file at pre-push time.

Scope — going-forward, not retroactive

The gate flags only evidence files that are **newly added relative to git HEAD** (staged additions under .lava-ci-evidence/ + untracked files there). Pre-existing committed evidence is grandfathered:

- many historical files predate §6.X (added 2026-05-13); and
- several document the §6.X-RESOLVED macOS host-direct + HVF gate path (a Linux container cannot reach HVF//dev/kvm, so host-direct+HVF IS the macOS gate runner per the §6.X 67th-cycle resolution).

Retroactively failing committed history is not the job (and the task constraint forbids touching real evidence). Enforcing the tag on the next file is.

"Records emulator execution" heuristic

A file is in scope when it mentions any of (case-insensitive):
adb_devices_state, boot_seconds, connectedAndroidTest,
connectedDebugAndroidTest, emulator-matrix. Files without these
markers (design docs, host-stability incidents, bluff-hunt logs) are
not flagged.

Accepted runner tag

runner: containers-submodule OR runner=containers-submodule, with
optional surrounding quotes/whitespace (matches both JSON and
key=value evidence forms).

Overrides

Variable	Effect
LAVA_EMULATOR_EVIDENCE_FILES	Newline-separated explicit file list to scan (hermetic-test injection; bypasses git-new-file detection).
LAVA_EMULATOR_RUNNER_STRICT=0	Advisory mode — exit 0 even on violation.

Usage

```
bash scripts/check-emulator-runner-tag.sh           # going-  
forward, strict (default)  
LAVA_EMULATOR_RUNNER_STRICT=0 bash scripts/check-emulator-runner-  
tag.sh      # advisory
```

Invoked automatically as \$6.X(6) from scripts/check-constitution.sh.

Hermetic test

tests/check-constitution/test_emulator_runner_tag.sh — the \$6.A
paired falsifiability proof: a fixture with a non-containers/absent
runner tag FAILS (exit 1); the same fixture with runner:
containers-submodule PASSES (exit 0); plus equals-form, non-
emulator no-false-positive, advisory-mode, and real-tree cases.
Run:

```
bash tests/check-constitution/test_emulator_runner_tag.sh
```

Two required conditions, not one (tightened 2026-08-26)

A file "records emulator execution" only when **both** hold:

1. **MARKER** — the file contains at least one emulator-run marker.
2. **ATTESTATION SHAPE** — the file *records* a run rather than *discussing* one, via either:
 - **(2a)** an attestation FIELD in key position — one of the §6.I.4 per-row field names ("avd":, avd=, | avd | and siblings) in JSON-key, key=value or markdown-table-cell form; or
 - **(2b)** a marker sharing a line with an INVOCATION or OUTCOME token — gradlew, BUILD SUCCESSFUL/FAILED, an instrument, --tests, adb -s/adb shell, avdmanager, emulator-matrix -<flag> — which is what a plaintext run log looks like.

Why the mention test was not enough

The previous version matched condition (1) alone, and asserted **in its own comment** that bluff-hunt logs "that merely quote a marker in prose" would stay clear because they are "unlikely to be NEW evidence files added in the same change".

That assumption was stated and never tested, and it was wrong. A §6.N bluff-hunt record was flagged whose only marker sits inside an "unconfirmed" prose field whose own text reads "*Gradle was not run (resource constraint)*" — so the gate was calling a written record of **not** running an emulator an unattested emulator run.

The tightening narrows by **what the file is**, never by where it lives: no path exemption was added, and a test writes a genuine untagged attestation *into* .lava-ci-evidence/bluff-hunt/ and asserts it is still flagged. Measured across all 117 tracked marker-bearing files, exactly 4 reclassify as prose; each was read and confirmed.